

South Coach Sees Good Series

By RAY BIRMINGHAM
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This weekend, 40 of the best graduated high school baseball players in New Mexico this past season will square off in the second annual North-South All-Star game at Apodaca Park, and to find a weakness in either the North or the South team would be like searching for a flaw in Rod Carew's batting stance.

"There just aren't too many weaknesses on either team," South Coach Darrell Bode, of Clovis, said. "The North squad is quite a bit like us. They are loaded with good hitting and good pitching which should make for a whale of a series."

The three game series between the all senior teams begins with a doubleheader on Friday at 6 p.m. and concludes on Saturday with a 2 p.m. single game.

"The North has a lot of good people," Bode said. "We won't take them lightly. I guess who ever wants it the worst will win it."

University of Texas at El Paso baseball Coach Andy Cohen has been selected as the guest speaker for the 6 p.m. home banquet on Saturday, which will conclude the All-Star activities.

In his 15 years as head coach at UTEP, Cohen has collected a 274-327 record, while competing in the tough Western

Athletic Conference. Last year the Miners finished 26-24.

For tickets to the All-Star banquet, contact Jim Barnett at 523-6320.

For Bode, who held two two-hour practices for his squad today, a first objective was to comb out and find positions for his four shortstops.

Steve Nunez, a shortstop from Roswell-Goddard during the regular season and one of the South's best hitters, will probably move to second base, according to Bode and Jerry Brown, a shortstop from Artesia, may move to first base. That will leave the shortstop duties probably to be shared by Henry Apodaca, of Las Cruces High and



Raymond Lara of Roswell. "We won't know who will play where until I have watched them in practice," Bode said. "I know some of these kids from our district (AAAAA), but right now everything is up in the air. We do know that everybody will get to play."

Last year, the North lost the opener, 5-3, as Artesia's Mike

Henthington and Mayfield's Orlando Lopez combined for a beautiful six-hit performance.

But, on Saturday the roof fell in for the South as the North won both games 20-12 and 14-1.

In the final game, the North blasted four home runs, three in succession.

This year Bode hopes to combat the North's good

hitting in the first game with the pitching of Roswell High's Jeff Myers. Myers finished the regular season with a 2.33 earned run average.

"Myers has a good curve ball, a good change and he really impressed me during the season," Bode said. "But, (Cloyde) Markham from Carlsbad is good and (Sain) Rodriguez from Carlsbad is an excellent reliever. Also (Mike) Archuleta from Alamogordo and (Javier) Holguin from Mayfield have good reputations, so we won't be hurting for pitchers."

With the talent that will be on hand for the two-day series, the college and pro scouts should be there in flocks.